SRUJANA TECH FEST 2026

Participant Rubric and Submission Guide

48-Hour Software Hackathon | Finance and Legal Services

What this guide is for

This guide explains how projects will be evaluated so teams can make informed decisions about scope, implementation, testing, and demonstration. It applies to both Finance and Legal Services. It is not a prescribed solution design. Teams are free to choose their own technologies, methods, and product direction.

Event dates: October 24 to 26, 2026

What judges value

A working solution to a meaningful problem, sound domain reasoning, strong implementation, tested behaviour, clear communication, and a realistic understanding of limitations. More features or more technologies do not automatically mean a better project.

Evaluation criterion	Weight	What this means for your team
Problem understanding and relevance	15	Explain the user, problem, constraints, and why your chosen scope matters.
Technical depth and implementation	20	Build a substantive solution; justify design choices and integrate the core workflow.
Functional completeness and reliability	15	Make the central workflow work end to end and demonstrate it reliably.
Domain analysis and correctness	20	Ensure calculations, interpretations, assumptions, or legal information are sound and explainable.
Validation and robustness	10	Test realistic cases and edge cases; explain data limits and uncertainty.
User experience and accessibility	10	Make the solution understandable and usable for the intended audience.
Originality and presentation	10	Show thoughtful choices and communicate your work clearly.
Total	**100**	All criteria use the same rating scale.

How scoring works

Judges rate each criterion from 0 to 5. Weighted points = criterion weight x rating / 5. The seven weighted scores add up to 100. Judges score projects independently before panel discussion.

1. How to prepare for each criterion

Problem understanding and relevance (15 points)

State who experiences the problem, what makes it difficult, and which part your prototype will solve. Explain your assumptions and why the selected scope is useful.

Technical depth and implementation (20 points)

Make the core approach real and demonstrable. Be ready to explain the architecture, important design decisions, integration points, and what your team implemented. Technology choice alone earns no extra marks.

Functional completeness and reliability (15 points)

Prioritise one coherent end-to-end workflow over many unfinished features. Prepare a working build and representative input data. Have a fallback plan if a dependency or network connection fails.

Domain analysis and correctness (20 points)

Check your calculations, rules, interpretations, and assumptions. Explain where the output comes from, what it means, and where it should not be relied upon.

Validation and robustness (10 points)

Test normal cases, unusual inputs, missing or inconsistent data, and at least one scenario where your approach may fail. Keep evidence of checks and be honest about limitations.

User experience and accessibility (10 points)

Make the main task easy to discover. Label outputs clearly, explain important warnings, avoid unnecessary complexity, and design for the people who would use the solution.

Originality and presentation (10 points)

Show why your approach is appropriate, what is distinctive about it, and what trade-offs you made. Communicate the product and its limits rather than relying only on slides.

2. Rating scale and what it means

Rating	Level	General meaning
0	**Not demonstrated**	No credible evidence; relevant functionality or reasoning is absent.
1	**Poor**	Major gaps; does not meaningfully satisfy the criterion.
2	**Below expectations**	Partially addresses the criterion, with substantial limitations.
3	**Meets expectations**	Competent, coherent, and reasonably supported work.
4	**Strong**	Well-executed, thoughtful, and supported by convincing evidence.
5	**Exceptional**	Outstanding quality, depth, correctness, and demonstrated effectiveness.

3. Rules and expectations

- **Technology freedom:** Languages, frameworks, algorithms, and architecture are your choice unless the organisers publish a separate restriction.
- **Data:** Synthetic, public, or team-generated data may be used. Do not depend on private bank records, confidential client documents, or paid services unless the organisers explicitly permit and support them.
- **Third-party tools:** Disclose important dependencies and distinguish your team's contribution from existing service capabilities.
- **AI-assisted development and reused code:** Follow the organisers' published rules on permitted assistance, attribution, and originality. Be prepared to explain and verify the work you submit.
- **Live evidence:** Judges may ask you to change an input, test a scenario, explain an output, or discuss an edge case.
- **Limitations:** Stating a real limitation will not automatically hurt your score. Unsupported claims or concealing known failures can undermine confidence in the work.
- **Professional boundaries:** Finance and legal prototypes should communicate relevant assumptions and uncertainty. Do not claim guaranteed financial outcomes or definitive legal authority.

The rubric rewards a credible, useful solution and the quality of the work demonstrated within the hackathon. A focused, tested prototype can outperform a broad but unreliable one.

This guide describes evaluation expectations. The organisers' official event rules, submission instructions, and published deadlines take precedence if they contain additional requirements.